

The Florida Bright Futures *Cheat Sheet*

Everything parents of 8th–12th graders need to know about Florida's biggest college scholarship, on two pages.

1 The two main awards

Florida Academic Scholars (FAS)

100% of tuition

The top award. Covers tuition and applicable fees at Florida public colleges and universities.

Florida Medallion Scholars (FMS)

75% of tuition

Covers 75% of tuition and applicable fees at Florida public colleges and universities.

Bright Futures also offers **Gold Seal CAPE** and **Gold Seal Vocational** scholarships for career and technical programs. Award amounts at private Florida schools are different.

2 Requirements by graduating class

	Academic Scholars Class of 2027	Academic Scholars Class of 2028	Medallion Scholars Class of 2027	Medallion Scholars Class of 2028
Weighted GPA	3.5	3.5	3.0	3.0
SAT	1330	1350	1190	1200
ACT	29	29	24	25
CLT	95	96	82	83
Service / work hours	100 service hours, 100 work hours, or a combination		75 service hours, or 100 work hours, or a combination totaling 100	
Coursework	16 college-prep credits: 4 English · 4 math (Algebra 1 or higher) · 3 natural science · 3 social science · 2 world language (same language)			

Highlighted scores went up for the Class of 2028. Only one test score is needed (SAT, ACT or CLT), not all three. **Classes of 2029–2031:** requirements haven't been published yet and have been rising, so plan for at least the Class of 2028 numbers.

The "Bright Futures GPA" is not the report-card GPA. It's recalculated using only those 16 core courses with Bright Futures' own weighting, so it can be higher or lower than what your student sees at school. Ask the school counselor for your student's Bright Futures evaluation.

3 What to do, grade by grade

8th grade

and the summer after

- Service hours count **during high school**. Ask your district if the summer before 9th grade counts, and start a log right away.
- Ask the middle school which high school-credit courses your student is taking (like Algebra 1). Ask whether they'll count toward the 16 credits.

9th grade

- Find out which form your school uses for service hours, and start a simple log (date, organization, supervisor, hours).
- Core class grades count toward the Bright Futures GPA from day one.
- Plan for two years of the same world language before graduation.

10th grade

- Turn in service hours at the end of each school year instead of saving them for senior year.
- Take the PSAT for practice and use the score report to spot weak areas.

11th grade

- Take the SAT, ACT or CLT. Many students test in winter or spring, then retake if needed.
- Ask the counselor for a Bright Futures evaluation to see which award your student is on track for.
- Check the hour total: 75 or 100 is the goal.

12th grade

- Submit the **Florida Financial Aid Application (FFAA)**. This is how your student actually applies for Bright Futures.
- Finish all coursework, GPA and hour requirements by graduation.
- Still short on a score? Keep testing. See the deadlines below.

4 Deadlines you can't miss

FFAA: by August 31 after graduation

No FFAA, no Bright Futures, even if your student meets every requirement. Don't wait; complete it during senior year.

Service hours: by graduation

Hours must be documented and turned in to the school before your student graduates.

Coursework and GPA: by graduation

All academic requirements must be met by high school graduation.

Test scores: tests through August 31

Scores from tests taken through August 31 after graduation are accepted for Bright Futures evaluation.

Get what matters each week, by grade.

Free weekly email for Florida parents: deadlines, Bright Futures updates, testing and one quick tip.

collegeplan.beehiiv.com